entrapment and abandonment,[52] bandwagoning involves risks of losing autonomy because of stronger states' political domination.[53] The basic motivation for hedging is to reduce the risks and uncertainties associated with a particular course of action – balancing or bandwagoning – by combining elements of both into a third type of strategy.[54]

Mixed behaviour, of balancing against, and cooperating with, is not a historical anomaly. Art observes that Britain pursued such a policy toward Germany in the 1930s, and that China did it against the United States from the mid-1990s onwards.[55] It means that various forms of balancing behaviour are compatible with hedging, although a policy along the lines of our narrow definition of hard balancing is not. Because the aim of hedging is to leave strategic options open without the need to choose balancing or bandwagoning, "following a hedging strategy will contribute to variations in state behaviour."[56] Differentiating between three types of hedging – extensive hedging (with an approximately equal mix of cooperation and confrontation), cooperative hedging (with a stronger emphasis on cooperation over confrontation in the policy mix), and conflictive hedging (with a stronger emphasis on confrontation over cooperation), the hedging framework enables us to address the evolution of India's China policy along the full spectrum between balancing and bandwagoning (see Figure 1.3).[57] Most importantly, this framework allows us to assess important changes and nuances in India's policies, indicating if New Delhi is increasing conflictive elements in its policy towards China, thus moving closer to balancing, or it is increasing cooperative elements, indicating a move closer to bandwagoning.